

We want to highlight the woman in the center- the working woman, listening patiently to what the other woman is saying. She could be making small talk or giving instructions, the working woman's weathered face with a hint of a smile is a picture of serenity in a somewhat gloomy surrounding. And it's the working woman's, the quintessential Shantabai, story we want to tell.

We want to accentuate the gloominess and focus more on Shantabai. She is the centerpiece of our narrative and everything else is just backdrop to contrast the sense of peace showing on her face. So without further ado, let's get it done!

Cropping

The first order of business is to sharpen the focus on the central woman. The photograph is too wide for our liking. And this is not the photographer's fault. Remember, it's better to edit the photograph than realise later that an important element in the picture has been missed.



Cropping is the most basic and a very important tool especially when you need to cut out the clutter

Also, it's not always possible to capture an image with the exact object in absolute focus. So in most cases, cropping would be the one of the steps you will undertake when editing an image.

We crop the image to an area of 2154 x 1560. Notice how your eyes are instantly peeled to the central figure. That was the intended effect.

Auto Tone

Although our protagonist is now in focus, her expressions, emotions, moods and the background setting is not yet clear. So we use auto tone to increase the contrast and the brightness.

The contrast is used to highlight the blemishes of the surroundings and brightness to get the woman in focus. This serves to lend strength to our narrative of peace in any surrounding. You don't need a backdrop of a high rise or a flashy car to be at peace with yourself and the world. Her expression